



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: It's better to explain things clearly when you want to train someone!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about people's interests and backgrounds using a wider range of language.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about manners and customs.
- I can use and pronounce words like train.
- I can stress new information.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever started something as a complete beginner? What was it?
- Which profession requires a lot of training? Why?





Let's Explore!

Jose is a quick learner, but he still needs to **train his ear*** to recognize some difficult English sounds.

* When you "train your ear", you practice listening for special sounds or information.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Jose:** Thank you, Frank, for agreeing to train me before my first shift.
- Frank:** That is no problem at all, Jose. We've all been there before, and I know how overwhelming new environments can be.
- Jose:** Yes. I am getting used to the way people behave here compared to in my country.
- Frank:** Oh yeah? What differences have you noticed?
- Jose:** For example, I found that no one really stares at you here when they speak. Where I come from, it's very common to stare at anybody.
- Frank:** I see ... Well, it's something that people find very rude here. You won't obtain any favors from anyone that way, especially from our customers! It puts a strain on the relationship between the waiter and the customers.
- Jose:** How do we stain them?
- Frank:** Strain, not stain. You stain something when it becomes dirty. A strain means a great effort to do something.
- Jose:** Thank you. Sometimes I need people to explain some words to me.
- Frank:** That's fine. I think you're doing great! Your English is not bad at all.
- Jose:** I'm taking evening classes on my days off.
- Frank:** That's a good idea. In any case, you don't need to speak like a professor to get started. It's better to communicate in plain sentences at first.
- Jose:** Hopefully the customers will understand.
- Frank:** Always repeat their order to ascertain that you got it right!
- Jose:** Ascertain?
- Frank:** It means making sure of something.
- Jose:** Thanks, Frank. You are a walking dictionary!





Let's Practice!

What words are stressed?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Circle the words that are stressed. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Oh yeah? What differences have you noticed?
2. I think you're doing great! Your English is not bad at all.
3. Always repeat their order to ascertain that you got it right!
4. We've all been there before, and I know how overwhelming new environments can be.
5. You won't obtain any favors from anyone that way, especially from our customers!



Let's Practice!

Jose reports about cultural differences.

Instructions: Read the text. Fill in the blank with the correct word. Read the text aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. used to / using / use to / used
2. stare / stares / star / glares
3. calm / calmed / common / come on
4. mood / wrong / crude / rude
5. most / many / money / much

I'm getting 1. _____ the way people behave here compared to in my country. For example, no one really 2. _____ at you here when they speak. Where I come from, it's very 3. _____ to stare at anybody. In America, it's something that people think is very 4. _____. There are still 5. _____ customs I have to learn here.





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue using words with the -ain sound.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- In pairs, write a dialogue (8-10) lines using as many words with the -ain sound as you can (at least 5).
- Try to write about manners and customs either in your country or another country you are familiar with.
- Share your dialogue with the class.
- Your classmates must listen for the -ain words and write them down.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about manners and customs.

☐ ☐

I use and pronounce words like train.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to obtain** (verb): to get; to secure something
e.g. You won't obtain any favors from anyone if you stare at people.
- **strain** (noun): severe or excessive demand on someone
e.g. Being rude puts a strain on the relationship between the waiter and customers.
- **to ascertain** (verb): to make sure of something
e.g. You need to repeat the orders to ascertain you got it right.
- **to stain** (verb): to discolor something with spots or streaks
e.g. I was eating spaghetti and now I have a stain on my shirt.
- **plain** (adjective): obvious, easy to understand
e.g. You should speak in plain English.





Learning Points

The Sound *-ain*

Diphthongs like *-ai* can be combined with a consonant to give a particular sound. The sound *-ain* is often found at the end of a word.

Practice pronouncing the *-ain* sound in the following words.

Example:

obtain	strain	ascertain	stain
train	complain	explain	plain

Examples:

- *You stain something when it becomes dirty.*
- *A strain means a great effort to do something.*

Stressing New Information

Sentence stress gives English its **rhythm** or "beat".

Word stress is emphasis on **one syllable** within a **word**.

Sentence stress is emphasis on **certain words** within a **sentence**.

Content words

- Content words are the important or key words in a sentence. They provide the meaning of the sentence.

Structure words

- Structure words are not important words. They are small words that you use to make the sentence correct.

Stressing New Information

You pronounce new information with more breath force, since it is more prominent.

Examples:

- *We've **all** been there before, and I **know** how overwhelming **new environments** can be.*
- *You won't obtain any **favors** from **anyone** that way, **especially** from **our** customers!*

